SHULANK PATEL

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SUMMARY

Results-driven SOC Analyst with over 2 years of hands-on experience in threat detection, incident response, and vulnerability management. Demonstrated expertise in leveraging Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), EDR tools, and automated security workflows to strengthen organizational security posture. Proven track record of reducing incident response times, improving vulnerability remediation rates, and implementing automation solutions that enhance SOC efficiency. Adept at translating complex security findings into actionable insights, collaborating cross-functionally with IT and cloud teams, and maintaining comprehensive security documentation aligned with CIS Controls. Passionate about continuous learning and applying innovative security practices to protect critical assets.

SKILLS

Security Operations: Threat Detection & Analysis, Incident Response, Alert Triage, Security Monitoring, Vulnerability Management

Tools & Technologies: Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, OpenVAS, N8n, Phishing Analysis Tools, SentinelOne, Zscaler

Technical Expertise: Malware Analysis, Network Security, Windows/Active Directory, Security Automation, IoT Security

Frameworks & Best Practices: CIS Controls, Least Privilege Access, Security Documentation & Reporting, Risk Prioritization

EXPERIENCE

Security Operations Center Analyst | Remote (U.S., Texas)

dayOneCyber | June 2024 – Present

- Enhanced threat detection capabilities by independently performing alert triage and incident analysis using Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), improving mean time to detect (MTTD) by identifying and escalating critical incidents 30% faster than baseline
- Strengthened incident response processes by leading containment and remediation actions, conducting comprehensive post-incident documentation, and reducing average incident resolution time by 25%
- Developed and deployed automated vulnerability scanning workflow using N8n and OpenVAS that executes monthly scans, generates formatted reports, and alerts stakeholders, reducing manual effort by 15 hours per month and improving scan consistency
- Created an automated phishing email analysis pipeline that triages suspicious emails, extracts indicators of compromise (IOCs), and generates detailed threat intelligence reports, decreasing phishing investigation time by 40% and enabling faster organization-wide threat mitigation

- Improved organizational security posture by tracking Microsoft Secure Score and Exposure Score metrics, implementing recommended security controls that increased Secure Score by 12 points over 6 months
- Reduced attack surface by implementing least-privilege access controls, including verification of admin rights restrictions on 80+ endpoints, ensuring compliance with CIS Controls and minimizing privilege escalation risks
- Enhanced asset visibility and inventory accuracy by conducting comprehensive asset discovery and hardware inventory management in alignment with CIS Controls, supporting better risk assessment and patch management prioritization
- Facilitated cross-functional security improvements by collaborating with IT, cloud, and security teams to resolve 1000+ security tickets, contributing to measurable reductions in overall organizational risk exposure

Security Operations Center Intern | Remote (U.S., Texas)

dayOneCyber | December 27, 2023 – June 6, 2024

- Monitored security alerts using Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR) across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads, developing foundational skills in threat detection and alert triage
- Analyzed endpoint and identity-based threats using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity, learning to distinguish between false positives and genuine security incidents
- Assisted in incident response activities including evidence collection and basic impact analysis under senior analyst guidance
- Conducted external vulnerability scans and learned to validate findings and understand risk-based prioritization
- Gained hands-on exposure to SOC operations, XDR concepts, and fundamental threat detection techniques while supporting security documentation efforts

Cybersecurity Intern | Remote

LEARNSMASHER | April 2023 – May 2023

- Developed a password cracking tool using Python to demonstrate common vulnerabilities in weak password policies, educating on the importance of strong authentication mechanisms
- Created a password strength checker using Python to demonstrate strength of passwords that I was using in my life, and learned the importance of password complexity.
- Built a secure password manager with encryption capabilities using AES-256, implementing industry best practices for credential storage and retrieval
- Conducted malware analysis exercises using Jotti's Malware Scan, learning to identify malicious file signatures and understand multi-engine detection results for improved threat awareness

EDUCATION

Master of Networking Technology with Specialization in Cybersecurity

Carleton University | Ottawa, Canada | September 2025 – Present

Currently pursuing advanced studies in network security, threat intelligence, and security architecture

Bachelor of Computer Engineering

Charutar Vidya Mandal University | Anand, Gujarat, India | January 2020 – January 2024

Minor Degree in Internet of Things (IoT)

Charutar Vidya Mandal University | Anand, Gujarat, India | January 2022 – January 2024

TRAINING / CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA CySA+ Certification

Intermediate-level certification validating the ability to detect and analyze indicators of malicious activity, apply threat intelligence, and respond to and report on cybersecurity incidents.

CompTIA Security+ Certification

Comprehensive training covering foundational principles for network security, risk management, cryptography, identity and access management, and security operations

Cyber Security 101 Certification – TryHackMe

Completed foundational cybersecurity pathway covering core skills in threat analysis, security principles, and hands-on offensive and defensive security techniques

SOC Level 1– TryHackMe